

AUTOMATIONS, WORKFLOWS & AI AGENTS

What is Automation?

An **automation** is any process where tasks happen on their own, without you having to do them manually.

- **Simple example:** Setting an email rule to move all invoices to a folder automatically.
- In n8n, automations help you save time, avoid mistakes, and get things done while you focus on more important work.

What is a Workflow?

A workflow is a set of connected steps that define how your automation works.

- **How it works:** You choose a “trigger” (like receiving a new email), then add a series of actions (like saving the email to Google Sheets, sending a Slack message, etc.).
- In n8n, you build workflows visually, by connecting different nodes (steps).
- **Think of a workflow** as the recipe that tells your automation exactly what to do, and in what order.

AUTOMATIONS, WORKFLOWS & AI AGENTS

What Is an AI Agent?

An **AI agent** is a smart automation tool that uses artificial intelligence to make decisions, understand language, and even hold conversations for you.

- Unlike standard workflows that just follow simple rules, AI agents can:
 - Analyze messages
 - Understand user intent
 - Respond to complex questions
 - Adapt to new information or changing situations

Example: An AI agent can read customer emails, figure out what they're asking, reply with the right answer, or send the message to the right team member.